

PERSONNEL

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City of Waterville

Appendix B Employee Harassment Policy Statement

Employees of the City of Waterville have the right to work in an environment free of discriminatory intimidation, whether it is based on race, color, sex (including pregnancy), sexual orientation, national origin, age (40 or older), religion, disability or genetic information. Engaging in harassment destroys this environment. It undermines morale, interferes with productivity and adversely affects the careers of City employees. When harassment affects employment decisions and/or creates an offensive working environment, it is a violation of Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Age Discrimination in Employment Act of 1967 (ADEA), the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 (ADA) and the Maine Human Rights Act. Offensive conduct may include, but is not limited to, offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule, mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures and interference with work performance.

Managers and supervisors must take prompt action to eliminate harassment, because it undermines morale and interferes with performance, as well as demeans its victims. Corrective action is required, regardless of whether or not the victim makes a formal complaint. Harassment by supervisors and/or employees of the City will not be tolerated. It is unacceptable conduct and will be considered good cause for disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

Employees who believe that they are victims of harassment should promptly report such occurrences to their supervisors so that they may be dealt with immediately. Employees may utilize relevant complaint or grievance procedures and may contact the Human Resources Officer at any time. Complaints will be processed confidentially and require thorough investigation of all facts and circumstances. Complaints will be decided on a case-by-case basis.

Employees will receive a copy of the City of Waterville's harassment policy when they begin employment. If the City should amend or modify the policy, employees will receive a copy of the amended or modified policy. If at any time you would like another copy of the policy, please contact the Human Resources Office.

Employees also have the right to file a complaint (in writing) with the Maine Human Rights Commission within six months of the unlawful act or unlawful discrimination. To file a charge or obtain more information on the procedure, you may contact the Commission by mail at: 51 State House Station, Augusta, ME 04333-0051; by telephone at: (207) 624-6290; or by visiting the website: <https://www.maine.gov/mhrc/>.